

First Workshop Q&A Recap - 4/16/2025

Trading Psychology & Risk

Emotional discomfort mid-trade usually means you're in too heavy or got in too fast. The trades that feel easy are often the ones you missed.

Even systems with a 75-80% win rate will take back-to-back losses. Accepting drawdowns and underwater trades is part of the game.

Stack small, high-probability wins. Don't swing for the fences stay in the game.

Use a structured sizing plan. For example: downsize after 3 losses, don't size up until you stack 4 winners.

Respect regime shifts.

After big wins, I sometimes stop trading. Go to the gym, hit the sauna, spend time with my family. I like to take a reset.

Market Analysis & Execution Tools

Footprint charts show actual traded volume at price, not just orders posted. Unlike heatmaps, they show who actually traded, not who flinched.

Depth charts show advertised liquidity, not necessarily real intent, especially in derivatives where leverage distorts size.

In uptrends, a rising bid that stays stacked shows strong interest and that participants want in.

In downtrends, the bid thins as buyers disappear and limit orders start to chase price with market orders.

In random or choppy conditions, the thinner side of the book often gives out, while the heavier side holds up. It's the path of least resistance.

Strategy & Tactics

Most intraday trades are noise. The real returns often come from swing entries at key higher-timeframe extremes.

Swinging partial size with the intention to add requires a different mindset and more patience than day trading. Perfect setups don't exist. Directional trading always involves uncertainty. Be ready to commit anyway on incomplete information.

Use tools like 20- and 50-day MAs to get a sense of trend and position sizing. Don't overcomplicate it.

Adjust expectations based on context. If one side is dominating but price is softening, don't force full trades, manage risk dynamically.

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Advanced Concepts

The options market is a trader IQ a filter. 25 delta skew gives you insight into short-term flow (1d1mo), while longer-term skews speak to almost constant conviction.

Ignore high-timeframe volume profiles unless price is probing extremes. Focus more on daily/weekly profiles and key inflection zones (ATHs, swing highs/lows).

In crypto, having access to flow, OTC desks, or inside network data creates asymmetric advantage.

For news-based crypto traders, speed of execution is everything. The edge disappears in seconds.

True pattern recognition and intuition, spotting them develops after years of real-time screen time, not backtesting.

Tools & Workflow

Coinalyze, Levitas, and AmberData are solid platforms for crypto spot, options, and futures analytics.

A Stream Deck with hotkeys beats mouse-clicking every time. Its ergonomic, fast, and keeps you present.

In crypto, order book heatmaps are often more useful than DOM tools because liquidity is fragmented and platforms have done a better job of making it easier to see change from a birds eye view. DOM use for me is a familiarity thing.

Volume clusters often form at whole numbers due to behavioral anchoring. Same goes for round-number magnetism in price.

Tape reading shows you urgency, and how aggressive are participants at new levels. Footprints help record that story.

Performance & Progression

Journal everything: your trades, thoughts, and emotions. Writing by hand improves recall and pattern awareness.

Know your stats: win rate, average return, drawdown, EV. You cant size properly without this.

Scalpers: if your MAE is greater than your MFE, youre toast. Thats a straight path to ruin.

75% of traders drop off within the first year. By year 3, its 85%. Be the outlier: build a system around your strengths, show up daily.

Trade conditions that fit your system. One-sided flow, volatility, and visible intent favor intraday setups.

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Market Behavior & Flow

Markets are driven by human emotion. That doesn't change, understanding psychology gives you the edge. In a purely random market, basic supply and demand still win out over time.

Conditions evolve. Static systems die. Adaptability is survival.

Price clusters around whole numbers for a reason—they're easy reference points and create subconscious bias.

Traditional DOM tools lose value in fragmented crypto markets. You're watching multiple venues and flows, not a centralized order book.